

Lights

It's a pain having to use your smartphone in dimly lit spaces. The built in flash just doesn't cut it whether it's a xenon flash or just a dinky little LED. To overcome this, the good folks at Manfrotto, the Italian company renowned for making some of the best tripods have diversified and have given us the Klyp.



More colours than the rainbow!

What it is, is essentially an iPhone case with mounts. You can mount the LED bank that comes with it on any one of the four mounts and pick one of the remainders for use as a tripod mount. The LEDs are balanced for daylight and since they run on separate batteries, they won't run down the charge on your iPhone.

A more than worthy alternative that's Android compatible as well is the Kick. Made by Riftlabs, the Kick is a bank of LEDs that not only serves the purpose of a constant source of light, it also comes with a whole lot of light effects that can be controlled via its smartphone app available for both iOS and Android devices. What kind of effects you ask? The Kick can not only project a myriad of colours, it can also mimic the flicker of candle light even the flicker of a TV. With no cables involved, the Kick connects to your smartphone over Wi-Fi and gives you a free reign over its features.

Last but not least would be the cheap and basic Pocket Spotlight once again from photojojo.com. It is a simple array of LEDs that can either be mounted on a hot shoe or plugged in to the 3.5mm jack on your smartphone. It's not exactly bright but what it does give is a reasonable amount of room for creative lighting without breaking the bank.

Of course it is possible for the average joe to make a simple LED bank at home and instructables has a few ranging from Light Boxes to Ring Flashes.

Shutter Releases

You get the family ready for a portrait and because you now have an amateur studio at your disposal, you mount your smartphone on your tripod, you set up the lights, you throw on the wide angle lens, your family is ready. Everything is set except for one thing. You are not in the frame and because you spent all your money on your smartphone studio, you didn't bother calling a photographer to take the shot. What are you going to do now?